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- ["ActiveCampaign", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) Senior Software Developer Owned core system testability and performance at scale, leading legacy modernization in a highly coupled CRM platform.">
 [{"name" => "ActiveCampaign", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) — Senior Software Developer
[Position](#)
- ["Business Decisions, Inc.", "location" => "Remote"}](#) Principal Developer Owned all technical strategy and system development, leading lifecycle modernization for multi-firm consulting teams.">
 [{"name" => "Business Decisions, Inc.", "location" => "Remote"}](#) — Principal Developer
[Position](#)
- ["BenchPrep", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) Senior Software Developer Owned enterprise assessment workflows, leading correctness and platform security in a high-concurrency environment.">
 [{"name" => "BenchPrep", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) — Senior Software Developer
[Position](#)
- ["BP", "location" => "Naperville, IL"}](#) Senior Software Developer Owned critical feature enhancements for an industrial invoicing system, leading performance optimization in high-volume billing workflows.">
 [{"name" => "BP", "location" => "Naperville, IL"}](#) — Senior Software Developer
[Position](#)
- ["Brightstar Corporation", "location" => "Libertyville, IL"}](#) Senior .NET Developer Owned enterprise supply-chain integration, leading cross-system data unification for a global mobile device distributor.">
 [{"name" => "Brightstar Corporation", "location" => "Libertyville, IL"}](#) — Senior .NET Developer
[Position](#)
- ["C.H. Robinson", "location" => "Oakbrook, IL"}](#) System Administrator Owned critical site infrastructure, leading early logistics workflow automation in a high-availability environment.">
 [{"name" => "C.H. Robinson", "location" => "Oakbrook, IL"}](#) — System Administrator
[Position](#)
- ["Coderwall", "location" => "Remote"}](#) Core Team Lead Owned platform modernization and open-source transition, leading infrastructure cost reduction in a community-driven ecosystem.">
 [{"name" => "Coderwall", "location" => "Remote"}](#) — Core Team Lead
[Position](#)
- ["EMR-Bear, a MedSuite company", "location" => "Remote"}](#) Development Manager Engaged on a bounded 90-day interim assignment to conduct rapid system cartography and operational risk assessment for a multi-tenant healthcare SaaS platform serving 130+ clinics following a founder transition.">
 [{"name" => "EMR-Bear, a MedSuite company", "location" => "Remote"}](#) — Development Manager
[Position](#)
- ["Groupon", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) Engineering Learning & Development Business Partner Owned core backend systems for fraud and taxonomy, leading global engineering enablement during hyper-growth.">
 [{"name" => "Groupon", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) — Engineering Learning & Development Business
[Partner](#)
[Position](#)
- ["Integrated Performance Solutions, Inc.", "location" => "East Dundee, IL"}](#) Programmer Analyst Owned dynamic reporting architecture, leading the platform transition from classic ASP to .NET environments.">
 [{"name" => "Integrated Performance Solutions, Inc.", "location" => "East Dundee, IL"}](#) — Programmer
[Analyst](#)
[Position](#)
- ["JPMorgan Chase & Co.", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) Assistant Vice President, Application Developer Owned cross-system integration stability, leading defect resolution in regulated financial workflows.">
 [{"name" => "JPMorgan Chase & Co.", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) — Assistant Vice President,
[Application Developer](#)
[Position](#)
- ["KloboMedia", "location" => "Remote"}](#) CTO Owned end-to-end platform architecture, leading high-throughput data integration for an early-stage social media startup.">
 [{"name" => "KloboMedia", "location" => "Remote"}](#) — CTO
[Position](#)

- ["Motorola", "location" => "Libertyville, IL"}](#) Senior Software Developer Owned retail feature delivery, leading iterative execution in a complex enterprise sales portfolio application.">
 [{"name" => "Motorola", "location" => "Libertyville, IL"}](#) — Senior Software Developer
[Position](#)
- ["New Labor Strategies, Inc.", "location" => "Park Ridge, IL"}](#) Programmer Analyst Owned kiosk-based HR modules, leading frontend modernization for high-friction factory floor environments.">
 [{"name" => "New Labor Strategies, Inc.", "location" => "Park Ridge, IL"}](#) — Programmer Analyst
[Position](#)
- ["Obtiva", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) Software Engineer Delivered backend systems and services as a consultant across multiple clients, including Sears, Leapfrog Online, and Groupon, supporting early-stage scaling and data-driven operations in high-growth environments. ">
 [{"name" => "Obtiva", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) — Software Engineer
[Position](#)
- ["OneMain Financial", "location" => "Remote"}](#) Associate Director, Staff Engineer Served as Senior Technical IC and Software Architecture Lead for the Acquisition lane of a regulated financial enterprise, combining hands-on system cartography with production stability, modernization, observability, and cross-team technical direction. ">
 [{"name" => "OneMain Financial", "location" => "Remote"}](#) — Associate Director, Staff Engineer
[Position](#)
- ["Independent", "location" => "Remote"}](#) AI-Augmented Systems Engineer (Phalanx Duel) Designing and building a real-time tactical game platform as a current hands-on laboratory for deterministic systems, product architecture, and controlled AI-assisted engineering. ">
 [{"name" => "Independent", "location" => "Remote"}](#) — AI-Augmented Systems Engineer (Phalanx Duel)
[Position](#)
- ["ReachLocal", "location" => "Remote"}](#) Senior Software Developer Owned API design and modernization strategy, leading incremental legacy migration for a high-volume digital marketing platform.">
 [{"name" => "ReachLocal", "location" => "Remote"}](#) — Senior Software Developer
[Position](#)
- ["Riverpoint Group", "location" => "Des Plaines, IL"}](#) Software Developer Owned reusable UI component architecture, leading frontend delivery for a personal health monitoring platform.">
 [{"name" => "Riverpoint Group", "location" => "Des Plaines, IL"}](#) — Software Developer
[Position](#)
- ["Sentinel Technologies, Inc.", "location" => "Downers Grove, IL"}](#) Application Analyst Owned custom web delivery and early OCR prototyping, leading cross-platform implementations for enterprise clients.">
 [{"name" => "Sentinel Technologies, Inc.", "location" => "Downers Grove, IL"}](#) — Application Analyst
[Position](#)
- ["SK Holdings, Inc.", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) Senior Backend Developer Led backend stability, performance, and modernization for high-traffic Rails products, improving full-text search, campaign delivery pipelines, and data layer reliability while systems remained under production load. ">
 [{"name" => "SK Holdings, Inc.", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) — Senior Backend Developer
[Position](#)
- ["Tandem", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) Principal Consultant Owned strategic technical assessment and on-site operational evaluation, leading architectural realignment and scope correction for a high-risk federal software program (DoD MEPS). ">
 [{"name" => "Tandem", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) — Principal Consultant
[Position](#)
- ["TicketsNow", "location" => "Crystal Lake, IL"}](#) Senior .NET Developer Owned real-time inventory systems, leading transactional integrity and iterative delivery for revenue-critical operations.">
 [{"name" => "TicketsNow", "location" => "Crystal Lake, IL"}](#) — Senior .NET Developer
[Position](#)
- ["Trippe Manufacturing, Inc.", "location" => "Chicago, IL"}](#) Software Developer Owned sales lead tracking systems, leading data automation and business continuity during a high-risk vendor transition.">

-  {"name" => "Trippe Manufacturing, Inc.", "location" => "Chicago, IL"} — [Software Developer Position](#)
- ["Upcity", "location" => "Remote"} Senior Software Developer Owned payment integrations and local development infrastructure, leading system modernization for an SOA-based marketing platform.">](#)
-  {"name" => "Upcity", "location" => "Remote"} — [Senior Software Developer Position](#)
- ["Viewpoints", "location" => "Chicago, IL"} Senior Software Developer Owned core business system development, leading AWS deployment modernization and CI implementation.">](#)
-  {"name" => "Viewpoints", "location" => "Chicago, IL"} — [Senior Software Developer Position](#)
- ["Independent", "location" => "Remote"} AI-Augmented Rails Systems Engineer \(WWWorkRemote\) Built a Rails-based data platform using PostgreSQL and vector search to ingest, normalize, and analyze large volumes of job data with controlled AI-assisted workflows. ">](#)
-  {"name" => "Independent", "location" => "Remote"} — [AI-Augmented Rails Systems Engineer \(WWWorkRemote\) Position](#)
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- [👉 214 Technical Conversations: What I Learned from the Creators of the Modern Stack 2026](#)
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Follett Software

Senior Director, Software Development

****Target Role:**** Senior Director, Software Development ****Lead Record:**** [[wwwworkremote` Lead #126\]](http://localhost:31000/admin/leads/126) (<http://localhost:31000/admin/leads/126>) / [Posting #5624](http://localhost:31000/api/v0/job_postings/5624)

****Company Profile:**** Follett Software (Chicago, IL / Remote — K–12 Education Technology, Destiny Library Platform) ****Tone Calibration:**** Understated, zero-fluff, honest level assessment. --- ## 1. Role Scope & Stack Analysis * ****Scope:**** Executive engineering director leading multiple product lines (Destiny Library Manager, Resource Manager, Accessit Library). Manages Development Managers and Senior Engineers. * ****Core Technical Mandate:**** Legacy modernization (Java, J2EE, .NET, JBoss, WildFly, SQL Server, jQuery → Azure cloud microservices), back-to-school peak load reliability, Spec-Driven Development, and AI workflow adoption. * ****Management Burden:**** Direct people management, performance coaching, succession planning, recruiting, and budget ownership across multiple product managers/teams. --- ## 2. Fit & Level Calibration (Skeptical Peer Lens) | Dimension | Target Role Expectation | Mike's Grounded Signal | Fit Status | | :--- | :--- | :--- | :--- | | ****Technical Mandate**** | Modernize legacy Java/J2EE/.NET monoliths to cloud; establish Spec-Driven workflows & telemetry. | Led OneMain Acquisition lane modernization, OpenTelemetry enterprise rollout across 36+ services, and 90-day EMR-Bear legacy audit. |  Strong Match | | ****Operational Peak**** | Ensure 100% uptime during high-stakes back-to-school enrollment peak. | Handled peak loan acquisition load; reduced system-wide MTTR by 60% via real-time tracing. |  Strong Match | | ****Role Track**** | Executive People Director (managing managers, HR reviews, budget tracking). | Principal Software Engineer / Staff Architect (Technical IC leadership; OneMain Associate Director was an IC corporate grade with no direct reports). |  Track Mismatch | | ****Work Environment**** | Heavy synchronous management & cross-departmental administrative meetings. | High-autonomy Principal IC track with async RFC/ADR documentation focus. |  Potential Friction | --- ## 3. Strategic Recommendation * ****Primary Recommendation:** De-prioritize for IC Target Roles.** If your job search priority is a Principal IC / System Architect role with deep technical ownership and low management administrative overhead, this Senior Director post is a structural mismatch. * ****Alternative Pitch (If Pursuing as Chief Architect / Principal):**** If Follett is attractive as a Chicago/Remote EdTech target, do not position as a people-manager. Pitch as a ****Principal Software Engineer / Chief Architect**** who will partner with their Director of Engineering to execute the multi-product legacy modernization (Java/J2EE → microservices), enforce Spec-Driven Development standards, and safeguard back-to-school reliability.